Langevin Autoencoders for Learning Deep Latent Variable Models [1]

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Motivation [2]

Learning deep latent variable models [3]

Latent variable models [4]

$$p(\mathbf{x};\boldsymbol{\theta}) = \int p(\mathbf{x} \mid z;\boldsymbol{\theta})p(z)dz$$ [5]

Gradient over model parameters [6]

$$\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}\mathbb{E}_{\hat{p}_{\text{data}}(\mathbf{x})}[\log p(\boldsymbol{x};\boldsymbol{\theta})] \approx \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n}\mathbb{E}_{p(\mathbf{z}^{(i)} \mid \boldsymbol{x}^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\theta})}\left[\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}\log p\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)},z^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)\right]$$ [7]

- To learn a latent variable model via gradient ascent, we need to approximate the expectation over the latent posterior $p(\mathbf{z} \mid \mathbf{x};\boldsymbol{\theta})$, which is intractable in general. [8]
- Variational inference is a dominant approach of approximation (e.g., VAE [1]), but the approximation power is limited.
- Markov chain Monte Carlo (MCMC) is capable of approximate complex posteriors, but is too slow due to datapoint-wise iterations.

Preliminary [9]

Langevin dynamics [10]

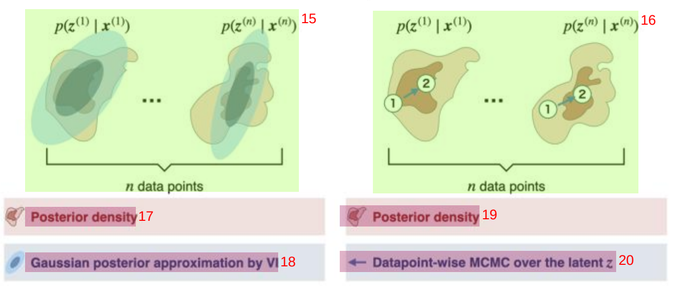
- Langevin dynamics [2] is a gradient-based MCMC. [11]

$$z' \sim q\left(z' \mid z\right) = \mathcal{N}\left(z';z+\eta\nabla_z\log p(\boldsymbol{x},z;\boldsymbol{\theta}),2\eta\boldsymbol{I}\right)$$ [12]

$$z \leftarrow z' \text{ with probability } \min\left\{1,\frac{p\left(\boldsymbol{x},z';\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)q\left(z \mid z'\right)}{p\left(\boldsymbol{x},z;\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)q\left(z' \mid z\right)}\right\}$$

- By repeating this iterative update, the samples asymptotically approach to the true posterior $p(\mathbf{z} \mid \mathbf{x};\boldsymbol{\theta})$. [13]
- MCMC iterations are independently performed for each posterior per datapoint $p(z^{(i)} \mid \boldsymbol{x}^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\theta})$ for $i = 1,\ldots,n$.

➡How can we amortize the cost of datapoint-wise iterations? [14]

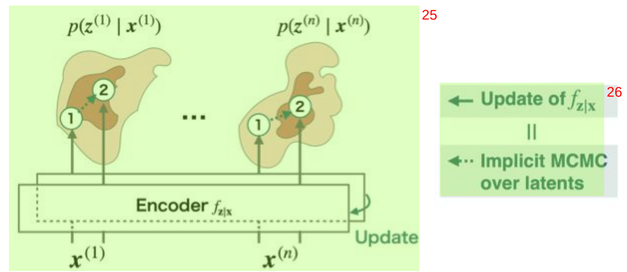


(a) Variational inference [21]

(b) Langevin dynamics [22]

Method [23]

Amortized Langevin dynamics [24]



- In our amortized Langevin dynamics (ALD), we prepare an encoder that maps the observed data into the latent variable, and run MCMC on its parameter space. [27]
- Markov chain on the latent space is implicitly performed by collecting the output of the encoder.
- Our main theorem shows that the ALD is valid as MCMC if the encoder takes the form of:

$$f_{z|x}(\boldsymbol{x};\boldsymbol{\Phi}) = \boldsymbol{\Phi}g(\boldsymbol{x}).$$ [28]

- It can be easily implemented using a neural net whose parameters are fixed except for the last linear layer. [29]

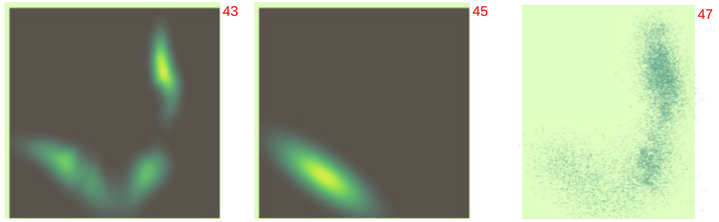
Langevin Autoencoder [30]

- ALD can be applied to the training of deep latent variable models (DLVMs) by slightly modifying the learning algorithm of traditional autoencoders. [31]
- We call this learning algorithm of DLVMs the ***Langevin autoencoder (LAE)***.

$\boldsymbol{\theta},\boldsymbol{\Phi},\boldsymbol{\psi} \leftarrow$ Initialize parameters [32]
repeat [33]
  $\boldsymbol{x}^{(1)},\ldots,\boldsymbol{x}^{(n)} \sim \hat{p}\left(\mathbf{x}\right)$ [34]
  for $t = 0,\ldots,T-1$ **do**
    $V_t = -\sum_{i=1}^{n}\log p\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)},\boldsymbol{z}^{(i)} = \boldsymbol{\Phi}g\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\psi}\right);\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)$
    $\boldsymbol{\Phi}' \sim q\left(\boldsymbol{\Phi}' \mid \boldsymbol{\Phi}\right) := \mathcal{N}\left(\boldsymbol{\Phi}';\boldsymbol{\Phi}-\eta\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\Phi}}V_t,2\eta\boldsymbol{I}\right)$
    $V_t' = -\sum_{i=1}^{n}\log p\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)},\boldsymbol{z}^{(i)} = \boldsymbol{\Phi}'g\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\psi}\right);\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)$
    $\boldsymbol{\Phi} \leftarrow \boldsymbol{\Phi}'$ with probability $\min\left\{1,\frac{\exp\left(-V\left(\boldsymbol{\phi}'\right)\right)q\left(\boldsymbol{\phi}|\boldsymbol{\phi}'\right)}{\exp\left(-V\left(\boldsymbol{\phi}\right)\right)q\left(\boldsymbol{\phi}'|\boldsymbol{\phi}\right)}\right\}$
  end for [35]
  $V_T = -\sum_{i=1}^{n}\log p\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)},\boldsymbol{z}^{(i)} = \boldsymbol{\Phi}g\left(\boldsymbol{x}^{(i)};\boldsymbol{\psi}\right);\boldsymbol{\theta}\right)$ [36]
  $\boldsymbol{\theta} \leftarrow \boldsymbol{\theta}-\eta\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\theta}}\frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=1}^{T}V_t$ [37]
  $\boldsymbol{\psi} \leftarrow \boldsymbol{\psi}-\eta\nabla_{\boldsymbol{\psi}}\frac{1}{T}\sum_{t=1}^{T}V_t$ [38]
until convergence of parameters [39]
return $\boldsymbol{\theta},\boldsymbol{\Phi},\boldsymbol{\psi}$ [40]

Results [41]

Toy example [42]



True posterior [44]

Variational approximation [46]

Ours [48]

- We perform posterior inference for a randomly initialized DLVM using variational inference (VI) and our ALD. [49]
- VI fails to capture the multimodality of the true posterior.
- Our ALD can approximate complex multimodal posteriors in toy examples.

Image density estimation [50]

	MNIST	SVHN	CIFAR-10	CelebA
VAE	1.189 ± 0.002	4.442 ± 0.003	4.820 ± 0.005	4.671 ± 0.001
VAE-flow	1.183 ± 0.001	4.454 ± 0.016	4.828 ± 0.005	4.667 ± 0.005
Hoffman (2017) [3]	1.189 ± 0.002	4.440 ± 0.007	4.831 ± 0.005	4.662 ± 0.011
LAE (ours)	$\mathbf{1.177} \pm 0.001$	$\mathbf{4.412} \pm 0.002$	$\mathbf{4.773} \pm 0.003$	$\mathbf{4.636} \pm 0.003$

[51]

Likelihood evaluation for test data [52]

- Our LAE consistently outperforms VI-based methods such as the VAE and other existing MCMC-based methods. [53]

Future works [54]

- How can we remove the bias of finite-step MCMC samples? [55]
  - Recently proposed unbiased MCMC methods [4] may be useful.
- Is it possible to apply the ALD (and LAE) to the state-of-the-art DLVMs, such as NVAE [5]? [56]

References [57]

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